

Love of Variety: July 9th Update

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1 Overview

This document serves to provide all relevant statistics and graphics garnered thus far in the Love of Variety research for my second year paper. My hope is that we are moving towards estimation with this smaller subset of data before expansion to other categories of products. I will be providing summary stats for the sample, statistics for switching behavior, graphics for variety seeking behavior, and then some graphics and statistics for the specific ways people switch.

My sample is of single person households in all markets. I filter to households which make at least two shopping trips. I created flavor bins at varying levels. First, specific buckets: 13 unique flavor buckets for popular flavors. Second, binary buckets: plain or flavored yogurt. Finally, the preferred three-bucket specification: berry, plain, other. This is preferred due to simplifying the dimensions of characteristics while also keeping variation in types of flavors.

2 Summary Statistics

Below, I list a table of summary statistics in table 1. The sample consists of 15,440 households which are seen for 16 trips on average. Each household purchases 2 yogurt cups per trip, on average. About 41% of the sample take the outside option any given trip. Brand choice is mostly static, with 75% of households buying the same brand from trip to trip. Flavor, however, is repeated 42% of trips. This shows that households choose to switch their flavor more than half of the time, on average. Households who are plain type buy plain yogurt more than eight consecutive periods, double the flavored types. Finally, 99% of households return to a chosen flavor after switching.

3 Figures

From the heatmap, we see that all three flavors are relatively close in terms of how long spells of switching are. These spells range between 2.1 and 2.8 trips, on average. Thus, we see similar variety seeking behaviors when households do switch.

Next, it is worth looking at the granular breakdown of variety when each major flavor has its own bin. When looking at figure 2, we can see that plain (the final column), has much longer spells on

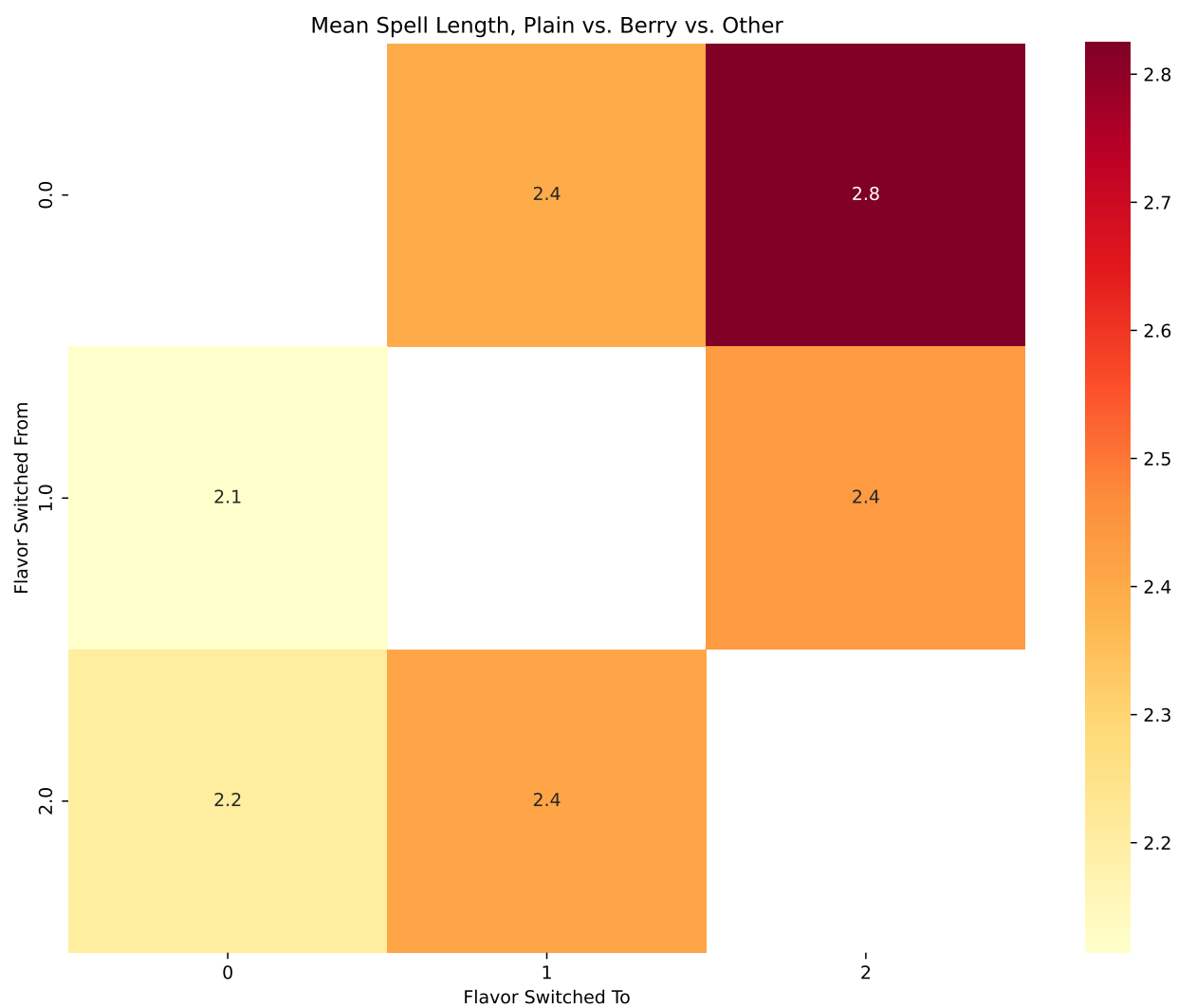


Figure 1

Table 1: Descriptive Statistics

Statistic	Value
# Households	15440
Mean # Times Observed	15.76
Yogurt Purchases	1.85
Mean Income	\$16,277
Median Income	\$16,000
% White	81%
% Black	13%
% Hispanic	4%
% Asian	2%
% Taking Outside Option	0.41
Mean Repeat Purchase Rate (Brand)	75%
Mean Repeat Purchase Rate (Flavor)	42%
W/in HH Brand Concentration	55%
W/in HH Flavor Concentration	41%
Mean Consecutive Buys per HH (Other)	4.2
Mean Consecutive Buys per HH (Berry)	4.2
Mean Consecutive Buys per HH (Plain)	8.5
Mean % Return to Past Flavor After Switch	0.99

average than the other flavors. For instance, when switching from banana to plain, the household will stay with plain for almost 6 periods.

When looking at figure 3, we see that plain households will buy plain yogurt 80% of the time while strawberry, column 10, is 50%. This further lends itself to plain households being stuck on plain while flavored households are more flexible or variety seeking.

Back to the three-flavor specification, I ran some analysis to tally up how many people are different kinds of switchers (1 bucket, 2 buckets, all buckets). The majority of households are only buying one flavor. This makes sense as plain is the most popular flavor. Close behind is the count of households buying two flavors. Finally, comparatively few households will buy from all three buckets. See figure 4 below. Table 2 shows that a majority of the households which do pick two flavors are choosing flavored combinations. This is again reinforcement of the idea that plain households are less prone to switching, making up a third of this sample.

Table 2: Flavor Combination Counts

Combination	Count	Percent of Group
Other and Berry	2659	66%
Other and Plain	891	22%
Berry and Plain	478	12%

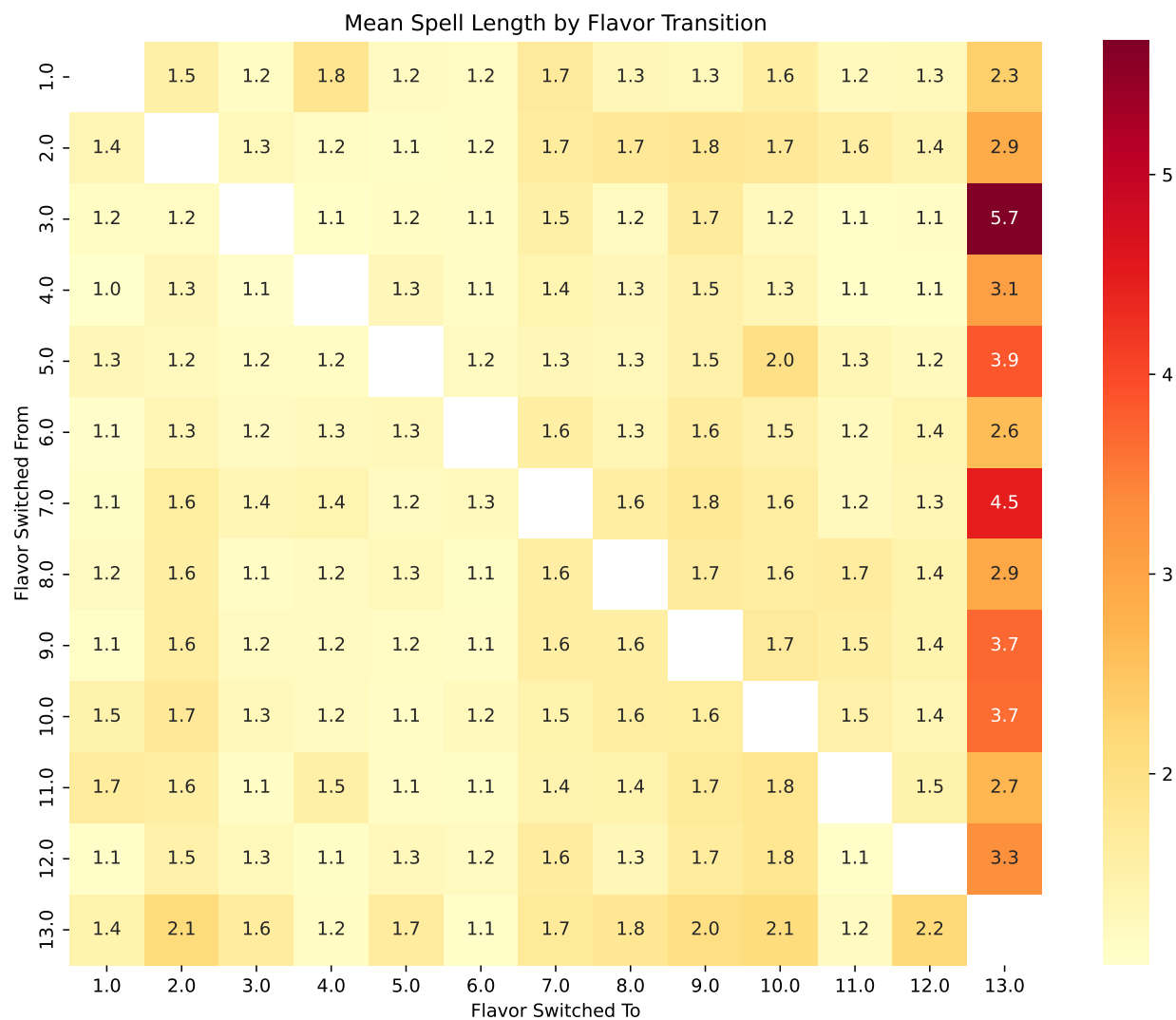


Figure 2

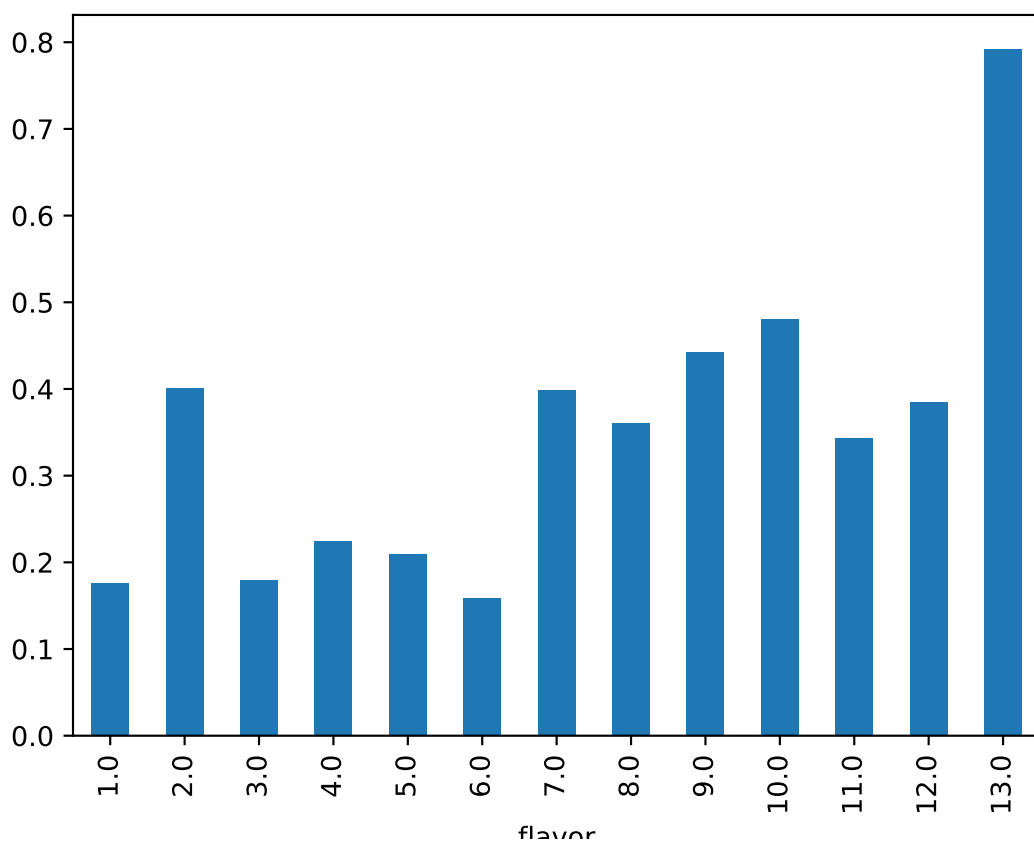


Figure 3

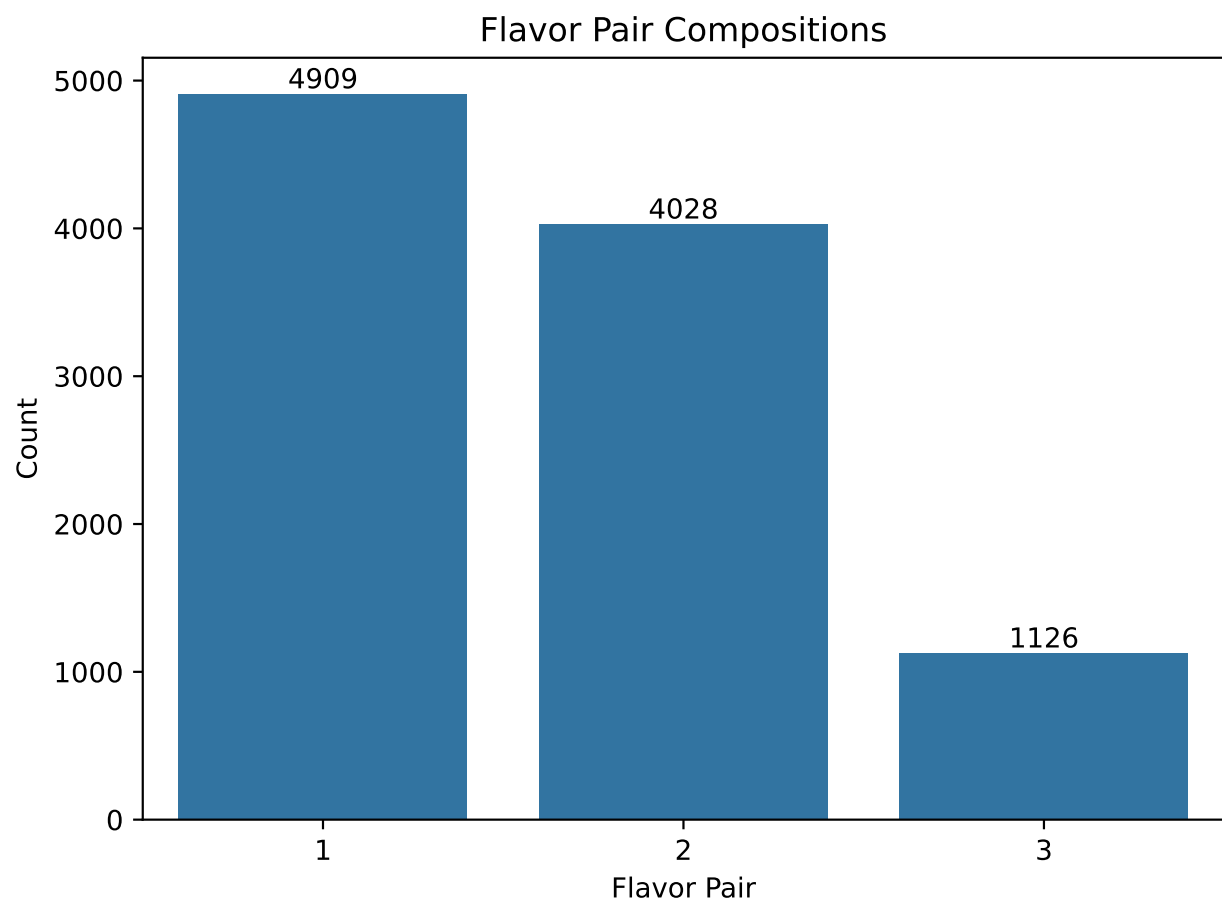


Figure 4

4 Concluding and Next Steps

From here, I hope to move into estimation. I would love to chat about using micro-moments for estimation. I think that it would be a good contribution to the literature, using these aggregated methods. This seems like a good way to proceed. I am also keen to expand the yogurt sample to more sizes and expand to more product categories (cereal and ready to drink beverages).

We can discuss further on Tuesday in our meeting, but I feel I am in a pretty good place. As always, comments are appreciated.